

An Introduction to NotebookLM for Beginners

MODULE I

- Define NotebookLM and benefits
- Access and navigate workspace
- Add sources and verify citations
- Generate Video Overviews basics
- Generate Audio Overviews basics
- Share safely with governance



Why this matters now

MODULE I

Information overload slows work

Hard to verify summaries

Prep time drains productivity

Stakeholders need traceability

Consistent assets accelerate enablement

Safe tools reduce risk

What NotebookLM is

MODULE I

Google research, note-taking assistant

Grounds answers in your sources

Works with PDFs, Docs, Slides

Supports pasted text, some links

Summaries, Q&A, synthesis support

Structured, audio, visual outputs



What NotebookLM is not

MODULE I



Not browsing the open web

Not a final authority

Not for grading decisions

Not for policy judgments

Not for sensitive data

Requires human review always

Access and interface basics

MODULE I

01

Open the NotebookLM website: NotebookLM.Google.com

02

Sign in with account

03

Create or open a notebook

04

See Notebooks list and sources

05

Find chat and Studio panels

06

Locate citations in responses



Safe-use boundaries

MODULE I

Upload non-sensitive, cleared documents

Prefer clear, well-structured files

Ask source-tied, specific questions

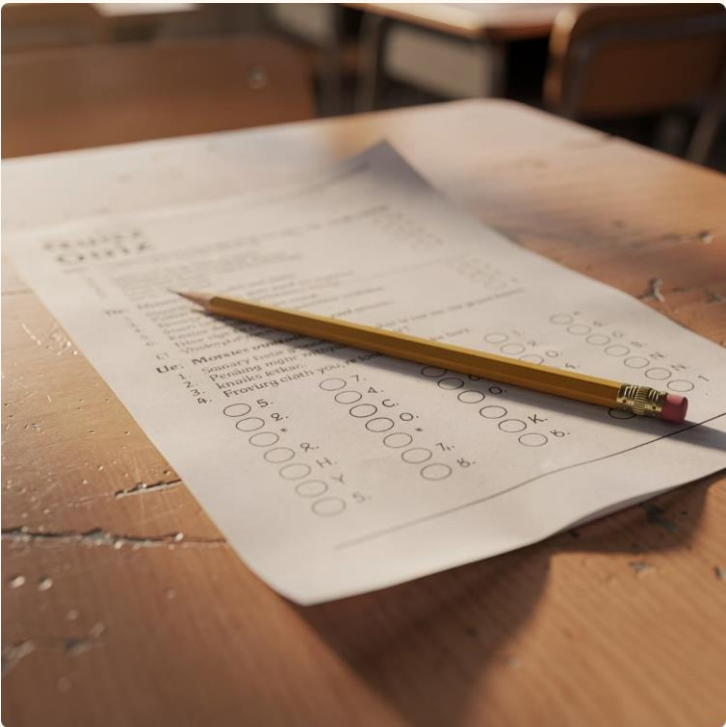
Always verify cited passages

Follow organization data policies

Treat outputs as support

Orientation knowledge check

MODULE I



1

Does it browse the web?

2

Where do you see citations?

3

How do you access NotebookLM?

4

Name an appropriate upload type

5

True or false: trust without review

6

Two transparency features expected

Core workflow overview

MODULE II

01

Create a new notebook

02

Add and manage sources

03

Ask questions about sources

04

Review responses with citations

05

Create outputs in Studio

06

Iterate and refine understanding



Supported sources and adding

MODULE II

Upload PDFs and Google Docs

Upload Google Slides and text

Add processable linked web content

Use multiple files per notebook

Title notebooks for findability

Keep sources organized logically

Q&A and citations

MODULE II



- Ask grounded, source-based questions
- Responses link exact passages
- Click citations to verify context
- Compare answers across sources
- Capture notes from verified insights
- Treat gaps as research prompts

Best practices and limits

MODULE II

Use clean, readable documents

Scope questions to uploaded content

Verify with original source text

Avoid personal, confidential information

Do not overtrust generated claims

Document assumptions and decisions



Individual practice

MODULE II

01

Create a new notebook

02

Add one safe test source

03

Ask three source-tied questions

04

Open citations each response

05

Capture one insight with location

06

Save note for later

Workflow knowledge check

MODULE II



- 1
Which sources perform best?
- 2
How to verify an answer?
- 3
Which panel shows citations?
- 4
Which panel lists Studio artifacts?
- 5
When to treat outputs cautiously?
- 6
Name three workflow steps

Studio and Video Overview

MODULE III

01

Open Studio in a notebook

02

Select Video Overview option

03

Generates video from sources

04

Edit access required to generate

05

Generation runs in background

06

Videos may include inaccuracies



Formats, language, styles

MODULE III

Choose Cinematic, Explainer, Short

Cinematic, Short support English

Explainer supports many languages

Select visual style if eligible

Custom styles for 18+ users

Optionally set focus topic

Timing, playback, review

MODULE III



- Generation may exceed 30 minutes
- Return later if still running
- Adjust playback speed as needed
- Rewind, skip, or full screen
- Mobile app limitations possible
- Note glitches and verify claims

Sharing and permissions

MODULE III

Share link requires notebook access

Public sharing only for consumers

Workspace Enterprise/Education disabled

Owners, editors manage public access

Alternatively share entire notebook

Or download and share file



Video practice

MODULE III

01

Open Studio, choose Video Overview

03

Pick a visual style

05

Play video and adjust speed

02

Select Explainer and language

04

Start generation and wait

06

Note accurate and questionable points

Audio Overview basics

MODULE IV



- Generates podcast-style discussion
- Grounded strictly in your sources
- Useful for review while commuting
- Model conversational analysis safely
- Verify claims via cited passages
- Choose audio when passive listening

Audio practice

MODULE IV

01

Open Studio and choose Audio

02

Generate from a multi-page source

03

Identify two to three claims

04

Open citations for each claim

05

Note one keep, one revise

06

Save takeaways for audience



Slide Decks, Infographics preview Module 5

01

Module IV

03

Initiate with titles and focus

05

Use decks for organized narrative

07

Plan deeper dive next course

02

Find options in Studio panel

04

Choose when structured visuals help

06

Use infographics for quick scanning



Stakeholder value and KPIs

Module 5

Module V

Reduce cognitive load significantly

Accelerate prep and content creation

Ensure traceability with citations

Decide by accuracy, speed, preference

Track assets per week

Track citation-verified accuracy rate





Adoption, governance, scenarios Module 5

- Module V
- Avoid uploading sensitive materials
- Do not use for grading
- Review all outputs before sharing
- Explain choice to skeptical stakeholder
- Write a five-point review checklist
- Select one KPI baseline

Final assessment and next steps

Module 5

Module V

Quiz on grounding and citations

Share one generated artifact

Reflect on fit and accuracy

Plan distribution and verification

Rate readiness to share safely

Follow-up courses recommended

